

Game Materials

Card Types

Module

Modules represent any exceptional equipment on a Ship. A Module is considered Active while face up, and Disabled while face down. If an effect would Destroy a Module, move that Module to Dead Space. If at the end of a Round a Ship contains no Modules, that Ship's controller loses the game.

Recruit

Recruits represent potential Members of a Ship's Crew. Each Member of a Crew joins with an amount of Morale specified on the card (see *Morale* in *Resource Values* (p. 2)). Recruits join a Ship's Crew face up unless otherwise specified. If an effect would Kill a Recruit, move that Recruit to Dead Space.

Action

Actions represent a choice a Ship and Crew made on their path to Terminus. Many Actions have a Requirement involving one of the Resource Values (see *Resource Values* (p. 2)). These Actions cannot be played if the Requirement is not met.

Complication

Complications represent the inherent unpredictability of running a Ship. Complications have a variety of effects and can be played at almost any time (see *Priority and the Cascade* in *Advanced Concepts* (p. 8)). Each Complication has a numerical value associated with it, called its Power. Power is only relevant during constructing a Deck (see *Building a Deck* (p. 4)).

Sector

Sectors represent a section of the galaxy on the path to the Terminus. Sectors are placed on the Star Chart on a specific Proximity Value and affect all Ships at that value, as well as the Crews of those Ships. If an effect would replace a Sector that was previously in play, the Sector being replaced is placed on the bottom of its owner's Sector Pile.

Resource Values

Proximity

Proximity is a representation of how close a given Ship is to the Terminus, the destination of the Space Race. Proximity is typically gained through Actions. As soon as a Ship reaches 10 Proximity, that Ship wins the game. A Ship cannot have negative Proximity.

Certainty

Certainty represents how much a Ship and Crew know about the true location of the Terminus. Certainty is the most common requirement on Actions, and is usually used to gain Proximity. A Ship cannot have negative Certainty.

Morale

Morale is a representation of the overall wellbeing and happiness of a given Recruit. Each Recruit card indicates how much Morale each Recruit should have when joining a Crew. Whenever a Recruit's Morale is less than or equal to 0, place them on the bottom of their owner's Gig Pile.

Reputation

Reputation represents the combined broad galactic sentiment about a Ship and its Crew. Some Sectors care about a Ship's Reputation, and some Actions require certain Reputation values. A Ship's Reputation can have a positive or negative integer value, or be 0.

Intel

Intel is a metric of how much a Ship and its Crew knows about the Ship and Crew of each opponent. Intel is tracked separately for each other Ship in the game. Ships cannot have negative Intel on other Ships. In order to Expend any amount of Intel, a player must have at least 1 Intel on that Ship. Whenever an effect requires an amount of Intel, it may only target Ships where the activating player meets the Intel requirement on the target.

Zones of Play

Hand

A player's Hand consists of all Actions and Complications that player is currently capable of using as options. At the beginning of the game, it consists of 4 Actions.

Ship Zone

The Ship Zone contains all of the Modules in a player's Ship. Modules are only considered Active while face up and in the Ship Zone. Players cannot have more than 10 Modules in their Ship. While a Ship has 0 Active Modules, they cannot gain Proximity.

Crew Zone

The Crew Zone contains all Members of a player's current Crew. Players cannot have more than 10 Members in a Crew at any given time. A Ship is considered Crewed if it has at least 1 face up Member. If, at the start of a Turn, a Ship is not Crewed, a Backslide (see *Backslide* in *Events* (p. 7)) occurs.

Pile Zone

The Pile Zone contains all of a player's Piles (Action, Discard, Complication, Sector, Upgrade, and Gig), as well as a player's Starting Sector. If a player would draw one or more cards from their Action Pile while it has less cards than they would draw, they shuffle the contents of their Action and Discard Piles, place them face down as their new Action Pile, and then draw that many cards. If a player would draw an Action while both their Action and Discard Piles are empty, they lose the game.

Dead Space

Dead Space is a shared zone where all cards that have been removed from play go. This includes destroyed Modules, killed Recruits, and used Complications.

Star Chart

The Star Chart is a shared map tracking the path to the Terminus. It has 10 spaces for Sector cards, one for each Proximity value beyond each player's Starting Sector. Whenever a Discovery (see *Discovery* in *Events* (p. 7)) occurs, a Sector is placed on the Star Chart. Players will also place a token on the Star Chart to track their current Proximity Value. The Star Chart also contains the Turn Tracker, where players will track the Turn Order for each Round. Ships may only be in their owner's Starting Sector, or on the Star Chart.

How to Play

How to Win

There are two basic ways to win a game of Space Race.

1. Be the first Ship to reach the Terminus by attaining a Proximity value of 10. (see *Proximity* under *Resource Values* (p. 2))
2. Be the last player with any Modules in their Ship.

Building a Deck

In Space Race, a Deck consists of 5 sub-decks, called Piles, totalling up to 60 cards. When building a Deck, select 10 Modules, 10 Recruits, 10 Complications, 10 Sectors, and 20 Actions. No two cards in a Deck may share a name unless they are Action cards. The sum of the Power values of Complications in your Deck may not exceed 10. Decks may not contain more than 2 Actions with the same name.

Setting Up a Match

Setup Phase

Before each match of Space Race, each player divides their Deck into its constituent Piles. The Sector, Complication, and Action Piles should each be shuffled, and placed in their respective space within the Pile Zone.

Once all Piles are in place, one player must be selected to begin the game with the Initiative. Players may use any method they agree on to select this player, i.e. rolling dice, voting, a round of Space Race. When a player has been chosen to start with the Initiative, each player should move to the Draft Phases.

Draft Phases

The first Drafting Phase is the Module Draft. Each player selects a single Module from their Module Pile, and places it face down on their Ship. Once all players have selected, all Modules are flipped face up simultaneously. Should any effects controlled by different players need to resolve in a specific order, the effect controlled by the player with the Initiative resolves first, then the next player clockwise, etc. This process repeats until all players have 3 Modules in their Ship, at which point unselected Modules are shuffled and placed in the Pile Zone as the Upgrade Pile.

After the Module Draft is the Recruit Draft. This process works the same way as the Module Draft, but using the Recruit Pile instead. When Recruits are flipped face up during the Recruit Draft, they join your Ship's Crew. After Drafting a Crew, each player shuffles their remaining Recruits and places them in the Pile Zone as the Gig Pile. Once all players have completed Drafting their Ship and Crew, they move to the Opening Phase.

Opening Phase

After all Ships and Crews have been Drafted, each player looks at the top 3 cards of their Sector Pile. They select 1 to be their Starting Sector, which will affect them as long as they remain at Proximity 0. Unselected Sectors are placed on the bottom of that player's Sector Pile in any order.

Once Starting Sectors have been selected, each player draws 4 cards from their Action Pile. They may choose any number of those 4 to place in the Discard Pile, and then draw as many Actions as they Discarded. After this, all players draw 1 Complication, and the first Round can begin.

Structure of a Round

Turmoil Phase

Entropy Step

The beginning of each Round is the Entropy Step. Each player with more than one Complication in their hand selects one and places it on the bottom of their Complication Pile. Then, all players with less than two Complications in their Hand draw one Complication.

Prelude Step

After the Entropy Step is the Prelude Step. Any Complication (or abilities that may be activated when you could play one) may also be played (or activated) during this Step. Once a player no longer wishes to activate abilities or play Complications in this Step, they place their Turn Marker on the Turn Tracker in the spot for their Turn in Turn Order on the Turn Tracker. Turn Order is determined as follows: the player at the lowest Initiative value goes first, with other players going next in ascending order of Proximity. In the case of a tie, the player closest to the player with Initiative (see *Initiative Step (p.6)*) clockwise goes first. Once all players have a Marker on the Turn Tracker, the Turn Phases begin.

Turn Phases

There are as many Turn Phases as there are players currently in the game. Each player becomes the Active Player of that Turn Phase in the order marked on the Turn Tracker, with the current Active Player being the one soonest in Turn Order whose Marker remains on the Turn Tracker.

Start Step

The beginning of each Turn is the Start Step. Some Modules, Recruits, or Sectors have effects at the start of a Turn. Those effects occur now. After any Start Step effects have resolved, if the Active Player controls an Uncrewed Ship, it begins a Backslide (see *Backslide in Events (p. 7)*), then a Regroup Step begins.

Regroup Step

At the beginning of a Regroup Step, the Active Player draws an Action from their Action Pile. Then, all of their Regroup effects trigger. Once all Regroup Step effects have resolved, the Active Player checks to see if they Deadlock (see *Deadlock* in *Events* (p. 7)). After Deadlocks resolve, a Play Step begins.

Play Step

During the Play Step, if the Active Player did not Deadlock, they select an Action from their hand for each Ship they control (see *Runabouts* in *Subtype Glossary* (p.9) and place it in the corresponding Ship Zone. They resolve all effects of their Action(s) in the order listed on the card, then an Aftermath Step begins.

Aftermath Step

Once all Actions have resolved, those cards are then placed in their owner's Discard Pile. Then, any Aftermath Step effects trigger. Once all of those have resolved, if the Active Player's Ship is in Backslide, they finish resolving that event. After Backslide has resolved, or if one did not occur, an End Step begins.

End Step

Here any "end of turn/end your turn" effects resolve. Once all effects have resolved, the Active Player retrieves their Marker from the Turn Tracker. If any Markers remain on the Turn Tracker, the next player on the Tracker becomes the Active Player of a new Turn Phase. Otherwise, the Tidy Phase begins.

Tidy Phase

Cleanup Step

Here, any "until the end of this Round" effects end. Then, any Ships with no Modules lose the game. Once completed, the Initiative Step begins.

Initiative Step

In the Initiative Step, the Initiative passes to the player at or tied for the lowest Proximity value next in clockwise order from the current player with the Initiative. Once the Initiative has been passed, a new Round begins.

Events

Discovery

Whenever a Ship is in a location on the Star Chart that does not currently have an associated Sector, a Discovery occurs. All Ships look at the top 3 cards of their Sector Pile, then place one face down next to the Star Chart. Then, all players reveal their chosen Sector simultaneously. If multiple Sectors are revealed this way, one is randomly selected and placed at that position on the Star Chart. All unselected Sectors are placed on the bottom of their owners' Sector Piles.

Deadlock

Whenever a player cannot meet the Requirements to play one Action for each Ship they control, they must reveal all Actions in their Hand. Once they've done this, they discard all of those cards and then draw 4 new ones. They do not play an Action this Turn.

Backslide

Whenever a Ship is not Crewed at the end of the Start Step, that Ship skips all steps until their End Step. At the start of the End Step, that Ship loses 3 Proximity and the top card of their Gig Pile joins their Crew. Once a Backslide completes, if that Ship is Uncrewed, all of its Modules move to Dead Space.

Advanced Concepts

Priority and the Cascade

Priority is the system that determines when players can take actions that are not locked to a specific Step, and when Steps end. During each step that is not part of a player's Turn, Priority begins with the player who has the Initiative, and moves clockwise around the table. Players retain Priority until "passing" it to the next player. During the Steps of a player's Turn, Priority begins with them instead of the player with Initiative. Once each player has passed Priority and any effects have resolved, the next Step begins. Players may only play Complications, or activate abilities that can occur when a Complication can be played, while they have Priority.

If a player chooses to activate an effect, or if a triggered ability occurs, those effects are placed on the Cascade. Effects are always added to the top of the Cascade. Effects on the Cascade do not begin resolving until all players have passed Priority on the current state of the Cascade, indicating that they have no more effects to add to the Cascade. While a player has Priority, they may add as many effects to the Cascade as they wish before passing Priority to the next player. If multiple triggered abilities are triggered at once, such as at the beginning of a Step, the affected player or controller of any affected Objects may order those triggers on the Cascade as they please.

Once all players have passed Priority on the current state of the Cascade, the effect most recently placed on the Cascade occurs. Then, if any effects remain on the Cascade, Priority is passed player to player again until no effects are added, then the process repeats. Priority is not passed around the table after the last effect on the Cascade resolves.

Objects and the Trigger Sequence

Whenever a card is in play in a Zone, it is considered an Object. The primary types of object are as follows: Recruits, which refers to Recruit cards in a Crew Zone, Modules, which refers to Module cards in a Ship Zone, and Sectors, which refers to Sector cards in the Star Chart. Recruit, Module, and Sector cards are also Objects of their respective type if they are revealed while in their corresponding Pile. Whenever a card is in play and is not one of those types in one of those Zones, it is considered a Special Object. If an Object changes Zones while there are any counters on it, those counters are removed.

Whenever abilities are triggered as a result of entering a Step, effects are placed on the Cascade in the Trigger Sequence, which is organized by Object type. First, all triggers associated with Special Objects are placed on the Cascade. Once that Cascade resolves, all triggers associated with Modules are placed on the Cascade, and so on for Recruits, then Sectors. The Cascade for one Object type must be completely resolved before any step-related triggers for the next Object type in the sequence are placed on the Cascade.

Miscellany

Keyword Glossary

Ambush - If this card is face down, you may flip it face up at any time you could play a Complication and activate this ability.

Bustling - Ships with a positive or neutral Reputation in this Sector may select to Bustle during their Play Step. When a Ship Bustles, its controller places an Action from their Hand on the top of their Action Pile. Then, they look at the top 3 cards of their Upgrade Pile. They may select 1 and add it to their Ship. They place all unselected cards on the bottom of their Upgrade Pile in a random order.

Chaotic - When this Sector is revealed, each player looks at the top card of their Complication Pile. They may put it back on top, or may move it to the bottom.

Comfortable - Organic Recruits gain 1 Morale each Turn they end in this Sector.

Exhaust - If this card is face up, you may flip it face down at any time you could play a Complication and activate this ability.

Extremophile - Whenever a Hazardous Sector would cause this Recruit to lose Morale, it gains that much Morale instead. Whenever a Comfortable Sector would cause this Recruit to gain Morale, they lose that much Morale instead.

Farsight - At the start of each of this Ship's Turns, if any of the objects in your Ship have Farsight, look at the top card of your Action Pile, then choose to put it back on top or into your Discard Pile. Multiple sources of Farsight do not provide additional benefit.

Feral - At the end of each of this Ship's Turns, this Recruit loses 1 Morale. This Recruit does not count for the purposes of determining if a Ship is Crewed.

Hazardous - At the end of each Ship's Turn, Organic Recruits in this Sector lose 1 Morale.

Neural - If a Ship consists entirely of Organic Modules and this Module is active, it is considered Crewed.

Override - During your Play Step, before revealing the selected Action, a player may declare an Override instead. If they do, discard an Action and activate one Override ability of a Module of their Ship, Member of its Crew, or their Ship's current Sector. Activating an Override ability is not playing an Action.

Petty - This Recruit does not return to its owner's Gig Pile upon reaching 0 Morale. While this Recruit has 0 or less Morale, its Petty effect is active. It cannot have less Morale than the negative of its Base Morale.

Research - At the start of each of this Ship's Turns after the first Turn, if this Ship has not gained Certainty or Proximity since the start of their last Turn, gain 1 Certainty for each Research Module in this Ship.

Shady - When drawing their Action during the Regroup Step, primary Ships with a neutral or negative Reputation in this Sector draw two Actions instead. At the beginning of the Aftermath Step, Ships that drew an extra Action that way this Turn must Discard one Action.

Social - Recruits join this Ship's Crew with 1 extra Morale for each Social Module in this Ship.

Unique - Players may not have multiple cards with this name in their Deck.

Weapon - If this Module is Active, at any time you could play a Complication, you may Disable this Module to Disable a Module on another Ship within Range of your Weapons. The Range of your Weapons in Proximity is equal to the number of Active Weapon Modules in your Ship at the time the effect resolves.

Subtype Glossary

Digital - This Recruit cannot be Killed or flipped face down. If this Recruit is ever in a Ship that contains 0 Active Synthetic Modules, move this Recruit to Dead Space. This Recruit does not count for the purposes of determining if a Ship is Crewed.

Legacy - At the beginning of Turn 0, this card is placed next to the primary Ship and remains active for the rest of the game. A Deck may not contain more than 1 Legacy.

Runabout - At the start of this Module's controller's Turn, they may detach up to 2 attached Active Runabout Modules with up to 2 Members of its Crew each. Once detached, each Runabout counts as a separate Ship with a Crew capacity of 2, with those Members being exclusively that Runabout's Crew, and not the original Ship's. A detached Runabout uses its primary Ship's Certainty, Reputation, and Intel. Players draw and play an additional Action per turn for as long as they control at least 1 detached Runabout, one played by the primary Ship and one played by a Runabout of their choosing. A player's Initiative is determined by the Ship they control at the highest Proximity. Runabouts can gain Members of their Crew as normal, but cannot receive Upgrades. At the start of any Turn that a Runabout is in the same Sector as its primary Ship while that is the active primary Ship, its owner may have it re-attach to the primary Ship, with all Members of its Crew being added to that Ship's Crew. Players win if either their primary Ship or any of their Runabouts make it to Proximity 10. If a Runabout Module is Destroyed while detached, any associated Modules or Recruits go to Dead Space during the Cleanup Step. If during the Cleanup Step a player controls a Runabout, but their primary Ship has no Modules, they lose the game.

Specific Rulings

1. Whenever a card becomes placed in a Zone and remains there, that card becomes an Object.
 - a. Whenever an Object changes Zones while it has counters on it, it loses all of its counters.
2. Within a Step, triggered abilities resolve in Module > Recruit > Sector order.
 - a. Special Objects, such as Legacies or some Actions, that specify they remain in the Ship Zone occur before all other effects. Special Objects that are placed on/around the Star Chart occur last, in ascending order of Proximity.
 - b. Even if there are non-Module contributors to your Research Trigger, all Certainty gain occurs in a single triggered ability, accounting for non-Module sources of Research.
3. If an Object is ever in a Zone
 - a. Whenever an effect would attempt to put a card that is not a Module or Recruit into the Upgrade or Gig Piles respectively, it instead moves to Dead Space. This does not cause triggered abilities associated with Modules or Recruits moving to Dead Space to activate.
4. Whenever an effect refers to a card being “revealed”, this refers specifically to a card going from unknown to known information. Examples include the top card of a Pile becoming known to all players, a card entering play from a player’s Hand, or a card that entered face down being flipped face up.
 - a. Effects that trigger when a card is “revealed” do not trigger when a card is flipped face up if that card was already known information.
 - b. Effects that trigger when a card is flipped face up do not trigger at all times when a card is revealed, such as when a card enters play face up.
5. If at any time a Ship is in a position on the Star Chart with no Sector, and any player has any cards in their Sector Pile, a Discovery occurs.
6. Whenever an effect would attempt to perform an action on an object that said object specifies cannot occur, nothing happens.
 - a. I.e. If an effect that says “Kill 1 target Recruit” targeted a Recruit with Digital, that effect would be considered “resolved,” but the Recruit would not move to Dead Space.
7. When a Step is skipped, none of the automatic game actions or triggered/activated abilities associated with that Step occur.
 - a. If a Start Step is skipped, the Active Player cannot begin a Backslide
 - b. If a Regroup Step is skipped, the Active Player does not draw Actions this Turn, and does not check for Deadlock. If this causes a player to enter the Play Step with no Actions for which they meet the requirement, they do not play an Action this Turn. Players do not draw back up to 4 Actions in hand until/unless they Deadlock.
 - c. If a Play Step is skipped, players do not discard down to 4 Actions in hand unless they Deadlock. No Actions resolve that Turn. This does not constitute a Deadlock.

- d. If an Aftermath Step is skipped, Actions do not move from the Ship Zone to the Discard Pile until the Active Player's next Aftermath Step. Ships in Backslide remain unable to play Actions until their next Aftermath Step.
 - i. Actions not moving to Discard until the next Aftermath also applies when the Step Order of a Turn is reversed.
 - e. If an End Step is skipped, the Active Player removes their Marker at the end of their Aftermath Step.
- 8. Face down Modules and Recruits have no abilities or subtypes (Arcane, Synthetic, Organic) unless the card explicitly states that a property exists while face down. Face down Recruits' Morale values cannot change, and they cannot leave their Crew due to having 0 or less Morale. Effects that can flip cards face up can look at the abilities of face down cards. This includes abilities where a card flips itself face up.
- 9. Whenever an effect "negates" another effect, the original effect is considered to have resolved, but does not affect the game state.
- 10. Whenever an effect prompts a player to "burn" a card, that player moves that card from their hand directly to Dead Space without resolving it.
 - a. Cards that are not in a player's Hand cannot be burned.
- 11. The Recruit named "Brtp" is pronounced identically to the English name James.
 - a. People named Brennan Lee Mulligan cannot win games of Space Race.